

Omur Damla Kuru

*Postdoctoral Fellow in City and
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Education

PhD, Public Affairs, *Florida International University*, Miami, FL, USA, 2022

Dissertation: Living on the Front Line: Community and Government Responses to Sea Level Rise in U.S. Vulnerable Communities.

Masters in Urban Design, *Izmir Institute of Technology*, Izmir, Turkey, 2015

Bachelor in City and Regional Planning, *Izmir Institute of Technology*, Izmir, Turkey, 2008

Research Interests

Environmental Planning & Policymaking, Disaster Planning, Climate Change Adaptation & Population Mobility, Housing

Professional Positions

Academic Appointments

Jul'24 - **Postdoctoral Fellow**, *University of Utah, Department of City and Metropolitan Planning & NSF WIRED Global Center*

Sep'23 - July '24 **Visiting Scholar**, *University of Massachusetts, Amherst, Department of Landscape Architecture and Regional Planning*

Jan'23 - Sep'23 **Postdoctoral Research Associate**, *University of Massachusetts, Amherst, Department of Landscape Architecture and Regional Planning*

Aug'17 - Nov'22 **Research & Teaching Assistant**, *Florida International University, Department of Public Policy and Administration*

Other Appointments

Dec'15 - Jul'16 **Senior Real Estate Appraisal Consultancy Expert**, *Form Real Estate Appraisal Consultancy*, Istanbul, Turkey

Aug'14 - Aug'15 **Senior Real Estate Appraisal Consultancy Expert**, *EVA Real Estate Appraisal Consultancy*, Izmir, Turkey

Jun'09 - Aug'14 **Real Estate Appraisal Consultancy Expert**, *Vakif Real Estate Inc.*, Izmir, Turkey

Aug'07 - Oct'07 **Research Intern**, *Izmir Metropolitan Municipality, Master Plan Bureau*, Analytical Investigation of Bornova District, Izmir, and revision of Master Plans at 1/5.000 scale

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Kuru, O.D., Infield, E.M., Renski, H., Shome, P., Hodos, E. (2026). Population Mobility in the Wake of COVID-19 in the US Northeast Region: Lessons for Regional Planning. Strategic Planning for Urban Sustainability (Second Edition) [Special Issue] *Land*, 15(1), 3.

[Doi 10.3390/land15010003](https://doi.org/10.3390/land15010003)

Shome, P., **Kuru, O.D.**, Infield, E.M. (2026).

Understanding US Internal Climate-Related Migration: Research to Date and Implications for Planners. *Journal of Planning Literature*. Advance online publication.

[Doi 10.1177/08854122261429510](https://doi.org/10.1177/08854122261429510)

Kuru, O.D., Ganapati, N.E. & Marr, M. (2023).

Perceptions of Local Leaders Regarding Postdisaster Relocation of Residents in the Face of Rising Seas. *Housing Policy Debate*, 1–22.

[Doi 10.1080/10511482.2022.2077800](https://doi.org/10.1080/10511482.2022.2077800)

Journal Articles: Under Review

Chandrasekhar, D., **Kuru, O. D.**, Garcia, I., Ganapati, N. E., Olshansky, R., Padilla, M., Matiz, A. Influence of Social Networks on Household Recovery Perception in Post-Hurricane Puerto Rico. **Under Review**.

Journal Articles: In Progress

Kuru, O. D., & Ganapati, N. E.

Rising Seas, Towering Challenges: A Review of the Barriers and Opportunities to Sea Level Rise Adaptation.

Chandrasekhar, D., **Kuru, O. D.**, Garcia, I., Ganapati, N. E., Olshansky, R., Padilla, M.

Interdependencies in household relocation decisions in aftermath of disasters.

Chandrasekhar, D., **Kuru, O. D.**, Garcia, I., Ganapati, N. E., Olshansky, R., Padilla, M.

Factors guiding business relocation decisions after the 2017 hurricanes in Puerto Rico.

South, J., **Kuru, O. D.**, Ganapati, N. E., Kalesnikaite, V., Baker, K.

To Support or Not to Support Managed Retreat: Understanding Stakeholder Policy Positions at State and Local Levels through Cultural Theory.

Kuru, O. D., Ganapati, N. E.

The Factors that Affect Local Governments' Responses to Sea Level Rise: A Case Study of Monroe County, Florida.

Kuru, O. D., Ganapati, N. E., Neshkova, M.

When the Game is Over: Considering Retreat in Response to Rising Seas.

In Edited Books

Kuru, O. D. (2024). Rising Tides, Surging Policy Agenda. In Fiorino, D. J., Eisenstadt, T. A., Ahluwalia, M. K. (Eds.). *Elgar Encyclopedia of Climate Policy* (pp. 123–128). Edward Elgar Publishing.

Technical Reports

Infield, E., Welch, P., **Kuru, O. D.**, Cotter, A., Renski, H. (August, 2024).

Insights for Receiving Communities in Planning Equitable and Positive Outcomes Under Climate Migration. Lincoln Institute of Land Policy, Cambridge, MA.

[Insights for Receiving Communities in Planning Equitable and Positive Outcomes Under Climate Migration](#)

Kuru, O. D. (2018).

Relocation, Repopulation, and Rising Seas – Monroe County, Florida, Following Hurricane Irma. Natural Hazards Center, University of Colorado Boulder.

[URL: Relocation, Repopulation, and Rising Seas, Monroe County, Florida, Following Hurricane Irma](#)

Other Publications

Infield, E., Renski, H., **Kuru, O.D.** (2025).

Climate Migration: Planning for Just and Welcoming Communities.

Fábos Conference on Landscape and Greenway Planning. 8(1). [Doi 10.7275/fabos.2752](#)

Kuru, O. D. (2021).

Managing the Known-Unknowns: A Review on Public Service's Responses to Emergencies, Crises, and Environmental Threats.

PA Times Online.

[URL: Managing the Known-Unknowns: A Review on Public Service's Responses to Emergencies, Crises and Environmental Threats](#)

Grants & Fellowships

2021	Dissertation Year Fellowship (DYF) Florida International University	<i>Tuition, insurance, \$16.6K stipend</i>
2021	Dissertation Evidence Acquisition (DEA) Fellowship Florida International University	<i>Tuition, insurance, \$8.3K stipend</i>
2021	ASPA Founders' Fellowship American Society for Public Administration	
2020	Dissertation Evidence Acquisition (DEA) Fellowship Florida International University	<i>Tuition, insurance, \$8.3K stipend</i>
2018	Quick Response Grant, Natural Hazards Center	<i>\$2K</i>

Selected Honors, Awards & Scholarships

2020	Public Administration, Public Policy, and Public Affairs Scholarship	<i>University of Michigan, ICPSR Institute for Social Research, Summer Program in Quantitative Methods of Social Research</i>
2019	NASPAA Emergency Management Poster Competition Finalist Award	<i>Network of Schools of Public Policy, Affairs, and Administration (NASPAA)</i>

Invited Talks, Presentations, Seminars

Invited Talks, Seminars, and Special Sections

- Dec'25 **Population Mobility in the Wake of COVID-19 in the US Northeast Region: Lessons for Regional Planning.**, WIRED Wednesday Seminar, NSF U.S.-Canada Center on Climate-Resilient Western Interconnected Grid (WIRED Global Center), (Virtual Presentation) Dec. 10, 2025
- Mar'25 **Receiving Communities in Rural Northeast: Lessons for Climate Migration**, CA+P 2025 Research Symposium, College of Architecture, University of Utah, Mar 4, 2025
- Apr'23 **Community and Government Responses to the Wicked Problem of Sea Level Rise**, Presenter: N. E. Ganapati Co-Author: **O. D. Kuru** at FEMA Vanguard Executive Crisis Leadership Fellowship Program, Miami, April 5, 2023
- Jul'21 **Post-disaster Relocation in the Face of Rising Seas: The Florida Keys after Hurricane Irma**, Senior Fellows and Friends (Virtual Presentation) July, 2021, <https://seniorfellowsandfriends.org/events/>
- Feb'20 **Back to "the New Normal" in the Face of Rising Seas: Sea Level Rise Adaptation and Mitigation in Post-Disaster Recovery Context in the U.S.**, IAARC Event: Let's Talk Research, Florida International University Moss School of Construction, Infrastructure and Sustainability, Florida, USA

Presentations at Academic and Professional Conferences

- Feb'26 **Preparing for Climate Migration: Insights from Emerging Receiving Cities**, Panel Speakers: Tim Robustelli, Patrick Welch, Amy Cotter, Peniel Ibe, **Omur Damla Kuru**. Consortium for Scenario Planning 2026 Conference, Lincoln Institute of Land Policy, University of Utah, Salt Lake City, Utah. Feb. 6, 2026
- Oct'25 **Roundtable: Emerging insights into post-disaster community relocation: from theory to implementation**, Participants: Divya Chandrasekhar (moderator), Rob Olshansky, Ivis Garcia, Santana Contreras, **Omur Damla Kuru**. Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP) Annual Conference, Minneapolis, MN, Oct 24, 2025
- Oct'25 **Receiving Communities in the Wake of COVID-19: Lessons from Rural Northeast Region**, Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP) Annual Conference, Minneapolis, MN, Oct 23, 2025
- Jul'25 **Receiving Communities in Rural Northeast: Lessons for Climate Migration**, Association of European Schools of Planning (AESOP) Annual Congress, Yildiz Technical University, Istanbul, Turkey, July 8, 2025
- Jun'25 **Receiving Communities in Rural Northeast: Lessons for Climate Migration**, MR2025 Mobility, Adaptation, and Wellbeing in a Changing Climate, Columbia University, New York City, NY, June 16, 2025
- Jul'24 **Transformational Change through Domestic Climate Migration**, Association of European Schools of Planning (AESOP) Annual Congress, Paris, France, Jul 8-12, 2024 (Poster Presentation Co-author/Designer)
- Jul'24 **Rising Seas, Towering Challenges: A Review of the Barriers and Opportunities to Sea Level Rise Adaptation**, Association of European Schools of Planning (AESOP) Annual Congress, Paris, France, (Virtual Presentation) Jul 9, 2024

- May'24 **Preparing Receiving Regions for a Just and Sustainable Climate Migration: Systems and Scenarios for New England**, National Planning Conference, Session Number: NPC2418544 (Virtual Presentation), May 9, 2024
- Nov'23 **Talking COVID, Learning for Climate Migration**, Northern New England Planning Conference, New Castle, New Hampshire, November 7 2023
- Jun'23 **Preparing Receiving Regions for a Just and Sustainable Climate Migration: Systems and Scenarios for New England**, National Science Foundation Sustainable Regional Systems (SRS) Awardee Conference, Alexandria, VA, June 8, 2023
- Mar'23 **The Factors that Affect Local Governments' Responses to Sea Level Rise: A Case Study of Monroe County, Florida**, ASPA (American Society for Public Administration) 2023 Annual Conference (Virtual presentation)
- Mar'23 **Perceptions of Local Leaders Regarding Postdisaster Relocation of Residents in the Face of Rising Seas**, American Society of Adaptation Professionals (ASAP), Climate Migration, and Managed Retreat Panel (Virtual presentation)
- Mar'22 **Perceptions of Local Leaders Regarding Post-Disaster Relocation of Residents in the Face of Rising Seas**, ASPA (American Society for Public Administration) 2022 Annual Conference, Jacksonville FL, USA
- Jul'21 **Relocation in the Face of Rising Seas: The Florida Keys Post-Hurricane Irma**, The 46th Annual Natural Hazards Research & Applications Workshop (Virtual Poster Presentation)
- Apr'21 **Post-disaster Relocation in the Face of Rising Seas: The Florida Keys after Hurricane Irma**, ASPA (American Society for Public Administration) 2021 Annual Conference Founders' Fellow Panel (Virtual Presentation)
- Apr'21 **To Respond or Not to Respond? A Review of the Literature on How Public Sector Organizations Address Sea Level Rise in the United States**, ASPA (American Society for Public Administration) 2021 Annual Conference (Virtual Presentation)
- Mar'19 **Back to "the New Normal" in the Face of Rising Seas: Post-Hurricane Irma Relocation and Repopulation in Monroe County**, ASPA 2019 Annual Conference Washington DC, USA
- Nov'18 **To Respond or Not to Respond?**, Sustainability and Development Conference, University of Michigan Ann Arbor, Michigan, USA
- Sep'14 **"Place-Making" as a Tool for Vital Public Spaces: A Review of Public Space with respect to "Spatial Organization" and User Participation through "Place Making" and Examination of Practices in Turkey**, Pro Walk / Pro Bike / Pro Place Conference, Pittsburgh, USA
- Jul'10 **A Review of Place Making with respect to the Interaction of Design and Public Use in Case Study of Sultanahmet District, Istanbul**, COAC International Workshop Architecture, Education and Society Barcelona, Spain

Panels, Workshops, and Webinars

- Mar'26 **Workshop: Elevated Coastal Communities Resilience Workshop**, Hybrid event, in-person location: Murray Nelson Government Center, Key Largo, FL. March 30 2026 (Workshop organizer, in collaboration with an interdisciplinary research team funded by Florida Sea Grant)
- Mar'24 **Workshop: Climate Migration Workshop**, Lincoln Institute of Land Policy and University of Massachusetts, Amherst. Massachusetts, MA. March 19-21 2024 (Workshop Organizer & Panel Discussant)
- Jun'20 **Webinar: Conducting Systematic Literature Reviews**, Florida International University Public Policy and Administration (Webinar Organizer & Presenter)

Teaching Experience

Main Instructor

- Spring 2026 **Green Communities (CMP 4380/6380)**, *University of Utah, Department of City and Metropolitan Planning*, Graduate-level course—taught in combination with the undergraduate course (CMP 4380), that introduces students to the definitions and applications of "green communities" by using a case study approach to understanding, designing, and planning "green communities." The course focuses on several international case studies to broaden the students' understanding of green approaches to planning and seeks to apply what they learned from international examples to Salt Lake City.—i.e., application of gained knowledge in the final project
- Spring 2025,2026 **Field Studies in Urban Ecology II (CMP 4020)**, *University of Utah, Department of City and Metropolitan Planning*, Instructor of the second of two hands-on courses in research skills used for urban analysis. Students learn how to measure and communicate complex, interdependent relationships within social, environmental, and economic systems. This course focuses on qualitative methodological approaches in urban research; practice how to apply the various methodologies to develop and implement a research study.
- Spring 2025 **Planning for Disasters and Environmental Change (CMP 6140)**, *University of Utah, Department of City and Metropolitan Planning*, Graduate-level course—taught in combination with the undergraduate course CMP 4140, that introduces students to the underlying concepts, analytical techniques and practices in disaster management, and environmental disturbances. The course also provides them with hands-on experience—i.e., application of gained knowledge in the final project, and site visits to agencies carrying out disaster planning practices

Guest Lecture

- Spring 2026 **Disaster Recovery Planning (PLAN 650)**, *Texas A & M University, Department of Landscape Architecture and Urban Planning*, Graduate-level course—developed and taught one lecture on population displacement, recovery, and retreat
- Spring 2026 **The Just City (CMP 4600)**, *University of Utah, Department of City and Metropolitan Planning*, Undergraduate-level course—developed and taught one lecture on environmental justice in the context of post-Hurricane Irma relocations from Monroe County, Florida

- Winter 2024 **Case Studies in Urban and Rural Climate Adaptation (REGIONPL 590X)**, *University of Massachusetts, Amherst, Department of Landscape Architecture and Regional Planning*, Graduate-level course—developed and taught one lecture on climate migration, managed and unmanaged retreat—with examples—as a response to climate change impacts
- Spring 2023 **Research Issues (LANDARCH/REGIONPL 635)**, *University of Massachusetts, Amherst, Department of Landscape Architecture and Regional Planning*, Graduate-level course—developed and taught one lecture on conducting focus groups, interviews, and obtaining human subjects review approval
- Spring 2023 **Applied Research Methods for Policy and Management (SUSTCOMM 297G)**, *University of Massachusetts, Amherst, Department of Landscape Architecture and Regional Planning*, Undergraduate level course—developed and taught one lecture on climate/environmental justice, geographic and social vulnerability to climate change
- Spring 2020 **Applied Research Methods for Policy and Management (PAD 4723)**, *Florida International University, Department of Public Policy and Administration*, Undergraduate-level course— developed and taught one lecture covering the main differences between qualitative and quantitative research methods and guided students to brainstorm on potential research questions for their research proposal project)
- Spring 2020 **Managing Global Cities (PAD 3800)**, *Florida International University, Department of Public Policy and Administration*, Undergraduate-level class
- Fall 2019 **Managing Global Cities (PAD 3800)**, *Florida International University, Department of Public Policy and Administration*, Undergraduate-level course

Student Supervision and Mentorship

Doctoral Student Mentorship

- Fall 2024 - **Mahdis Borhani (Ph.D. Student)**, *City and Metropolitan Planning Department, University of Utah*. Role: Research advising on project development, data collection, and analysis, and obtaining human subjects review approval for student's project "A Framework for Wildfire Resilience for Utility Planning in the Western Interconnection"
- Fall 2024 - **Tasnim Isaba (Ph.D. Student)**, *City and Metropolitan Planning Department, University of Utah*. Role: Research advising on project development, data collection, and analysis for the student's projects—a systematic literature review and a survey development on wildfire management in the US
- Spring - **Paromita Shome (Ph.D. Student)**, *Landscape Architecture and Regional Planning Department, University of Massachusetts, Amherst*. Role: Research advising on project development, data collection and analysis, and article writing for the student's project "Understanding US Internal Climate-related Migration: Research to Date and Implications for Planners"

Masters Student Mentorship

- Fall 2024 - **Suraksha Bhandari (Masters Student)**, City and Metropolitan Planning Department, University of Utah. Role: Research advising on project development and data analysis for the student's project on housing resilience in Utah
- Spring 2025 - **Emily Hodos (Masters Student)**, Landscape Architecture and Regional Planning Department, University of Massachusetts, Amherst. Role: Research advising on writing master thesis on housing resilience in Utah

Undergraduate Student Mentorship

- Fall 2025, Spring 2026 - **Hyein Kim (Undergraduate Student)**, City and Metropolitan Planning Department, University of Utah, Asia Campus. Role: Research advising on proposal writing, project management and research report writing for student's project "Wildfire Resilience: A comparative case study of Utah and South Korea"
- Summer 2025 - **Hayden W. Mattingly (Undergraduate Student)**, City and Metropolitan Planning Department, University of Utah. Role: Research advising on project development and obtaining human subjects review approval on the project that student worked on, "A Framework for Wildfire Resilience for Utility Planning in the Western Interconnection"
- Spring 2025 - **Arthur S. Fainkich (Undergraduate Student)**, City and Metropolitan Planning Department, University of Utah. Role: Research advising on data collection and analysis for a systematic literature and policy review on wildfire management in the U.S
- Fall 2021 - **12 Undergraduate students**, Public Policy and Administration Department, Florida International University, Advising 12 mentees for their Capstone Project in Integrative Seminar in Public Administration Course (PAD 4934)

Service

- 2024 **Workshop Organizer**, Climate Migration Workshop, Organized by Lincoln Institute of Land Policy and University of Massachusetts, Amherst. March 19-21, 2024, Lincoln Institute of Land Policy, Cambridge, MA, USA
- 2019 **Student Volunteer**, 44th Annual Natural Hazards Research & Applications Workshop, Colorado, USA
- 2019 **Committee Member**, Global Planning Educators Interest Group Logo Competition, USA
- 2019 **Student Volunteer**, ASPA 2019 Annual Conference, Washington DC, USA

Certificates

- May'13 ExpropriationExpertise *Expropriation Expertise Education by Turkey Real Estate Appraisal Consultants Union, Istanbul'13*
- Aug'12 Capital Markets Board of Turkey *Real Estate Appraisal Licence No: 402525*

———— Languages

Turkish Native speaker

English Advanced

French Intermediate

Read Written Spoken

Read Written Spoken

———— Computer Skills

Mainstream NVivo, Stata, SPSS, AutoCad, GIS, QGIS, ArchiCAD, Photoshop, 3D Max

Functional MS Office, Open Office

———— References

○ Available on Request